
THE GOSPEL OF MARK • CHAPTER 4

Listen. Grow. Shine. Trust.

A Bible study about seeds, light,
and faith when storms come.

“He who has ears to hear, let him hear!”



Jesus brought the lesson to everyone



SYNAGOGUE

to the seaside

Jesus moved where more people could hear Him. The boat became His teaching place, and the shore became a classroom.

Why parables?

They use familiar things—seeds, lamps, weather—to explain truths that are hard to see.

LISTEN FOR THE BIG IDEA, NOT JUST THE STORY.

The seed is the same. The hearts are different.

The seed is God's word, offered freely to everyone.



1

PATH

The word is taken away

Ask: What distracts me?

2

ROCKY

Joy without roots

Ask: How can I go deeper?

3

THORNY

Worries crowd it out

Ask: What fills my attention?

4

GOOD SOIL

Hear • accept • bear fruit

Ask: What can I practice?

Only good soil holds the word long enough for it to grow and multiply.

Your gifts are light—meant to be shared

A lamp does not belong under a basket. In the same way, God-given talents grow when we use them to serve others.

1

NOTICE

Who needs encouragement?

2

OFFER

Use what you do well.

3

PRACTICE

Small acts make gifts stronger.



What gift has God given you—and who could it help this week?

What you listen to can grow in you

“Take heed what you hear.”

Jesus does not ask us only to hear words. He asks us to pay attention, think deeply, and let the truth take root.

- 1 HEAR** Slow down enough to notice.
- 2 CONSIDER** Ask what the word means for you.
- 3 ACT** Practice it so it multiplies.



The more faithfully we use what God gives, the more room it has to grow.

The measure we use matters

**“With the same measure you use,
it will be measured to you.”**

WHEN I JUDGE OTHERS

**Am I quick to assume
the worst?**

Harsh words and unfair guesses
can hurt people.

THE MEASURE JESUS TEACHES

**Choose mercy before
criticism.**

**Be patient • be fair • forgive •
leave final judgment to God.**

**Before judging someone, ask: “Would I want this same measure used
for me?”**



God grows what we cannot see

A farmer scatters seed, sleeps, wakes—and the seed grows. He cannot explain every step.

- FIRST** a blade
- THEN** a head
- FINALLY** full grain

The Holy Spirit can be working in a person before anyone sees the change.



Tiny beginning. Kingdom-sized growth.

“It grows up ... and shoots out large branches.”

TINY SEED God’s word can begin quietly in one heart.

ABOUT 120 believers gathered in Acts—then the Gospel spread far beyond them.

LARGE BRANCHES God’s kingdom reaches outward and makes room for many.

Mustard seed → tree

Young believer → glorified saint



Love keeps the Gospel moving

EVENING

after a full day of teaching

OTHER SIDE

a new shore and more people

Jesus chose to cross the lake at night. His mission mattered enough to keep going—even when He was tired.

He cared that much about people hearing the Good News—including you and me.



Faith can be louder than fear

The boat was filling. The disciples thought Jesus did not care.

“Peace, be still!”

The wind stopped. The sea became calm. Jesus wanted their faith to overcome their fear.

**Jesus is never absent in hard moments.
He is with us—even when He seems quiet.**

Mark 4 gives us four moves for the week

1

LISTEN

Read a few verses
without rushing.

2

GROW

Choose one truth
to practice.

3

SHINE

Use one gift
to help someone.

4

TRUST

Name one fear
and pray about it.

Which part of your “soil” needs God’s help right now?

Closing prayer

*Jesus, help us hear Your word, let it grow, share Your light,
and trust You when we are afraid. Amen.*